had not understood and could not explain what had happened right before their eyes.

I loved the man. His personality and his knowledge filled me with confidence. Wherever I was, I had the feeling that if I looked behind me I would see him, giving me a wink.

There was no precedent to the unique and personal attention Yitzhak gave to the combatants and employees of the Mossad, and unfortunately, since his passing no one has lived up to the standard he set. I miss him every day.

On the Israeli-Palestinian Conflict

This section was written in a time tunnel. It was penned in mid-2016, but its content and the opinions expressed in it date back to the decade between September 2001 and September 2010, though I do occasionally slip in the views I hold today. This lends validity to the statement attributed to the late Moshe Dayan, that "only donkeys do not change their minds!" The opinions I hold today are expressed in detail in the following section "A Parallel Arrangement—An Alternative to Bilateral Negotiations."

In September 2001, I was in the midst of making the shift from my second career to my third. My first career was, of course, the thirty-two years I spent in the Mossad, the pinnacle of which was my service as its director from 1989 to 1996. In my second career, I served as the CEO of Maccabi Healthcare Services, the second-largest HMO in Israel, between the years 1996 and 2001. Then, in August 2001, I began my third chapter in the business world in the field of energy, advancing the natural gas agreement between Egypt and Israel.

On the afternoon of September 11, 2001, I was sitting in my office, engrossed in some energy-related reading material, when the phone on my desk rang. I picked up and immediately recognized the voice of an old friend, the former head of the CIA's Near East Division. Skipping the usual opening niceties characteristic of phone calls, he said "Shabtai, turn on CNN and call me back." I hurried into the next room and turned on the TV just in time to see the second plane crash into the second Twin Tower. I sat down on the couch, stared at the television screen, and murmured to myself and to the people who had begun to gather in the room, "As of today we